

MARIA MONTESSORI INTERNATIONAL ACADEMY

Encouraging imagination, exploration and innovation.

At Maria Montessori International Academy (MMIA), your child is welcomed into a warm, peaceful setting that invites imagination, exploration and innovation throughout our authentic Montessori education. Every day offers promise for discovery, fun and growth.

We're dedicated to preparing your child for life. Our MMIA schools feature Montessori materials and environments that invite children to explore real-life learning experiences, music, math, social sciences, Spanish immersion, cultural awareness and art.

Our MMIA History

PREPARING CHILDREN FOR LIFE

MMIA Environment

MMIA adheres to these Montessori principles:

- Sensorial development
- Mixed-age groups
- Allowing child to work at his or her own pace
- Providing freedom to choose his or her own work
- An environment that encourages discipline
- Home-like setting

MMIA Education

MMIA's curriculum includes:

- Spanish immersion, Chinese
- Music and art
- Geography and cultural studies
- Math, science and language (phonetics)
- Practical life skills
- Emphasis on cognitive and social development
- Overall academic excellence

MMIA Teachers

Our MMIA teachers have the following qualities:

- Demonstrated passion for teaching
- Certified by American Montessori Society or the Association Montessori Internationale
- Received a bachelor's and/or master's degree
- Adhere to Montessori philosophy of respect to the child as an individual

MMIA Community

At MMIA, we recognize the importance of family and community in nurturing the child. We provide:

- Regular updates on the child
- Tips on creating a Montessori home environment
- Flexible programs (part-time, full-time, extended care, summer camp) to accommodate working parents and stay-at-home parents
- Supplementary programs and instruction

MMIA FAMILIES

At Maria Montessori International Academy, we want families to be an integral part of their child's journey to lifelong learning. We keep families updated through regular communications, including insights on their child's daily activities and one-on-one conversations. It's also important for us to receive feedback from our MMIA families. From what they tell us, MMIA has been an environment that allows their children to thrive. Here are a few comments from some of our MMIA parents.

"It's like home ..."

"It's very rare you're able to send your child somewhere and feel comfortable all the way around. The education at Maria Montessori International Academy is excellent. I still have a recording of my daughter reading for the first time on her own. And that was before her fourth birthday. But it goes beyond education. We had a good genuine feel about the atmosphere. It's like home. It also allowed my daughter open up to her creativity."

Andrell Moore

Parent of 1st grader

"The kids love it."

"I didn't know much about Montessori when we first visited. It was very different. The students are able to wear their slippers, hang out on the floor and do yoga. My daughter's classroom is like a little family. They love it. It was a stretch for me but I see the magic it has had on my child. In a traditional setting, if a student gets tripped upon something, they would get left behind. Here, they're able to sit back, reflect and work at their pace. My daughter loves the work"

Teresa Gallaway

Parent of elementary student

"One-on-one attention."

"I liked the idea of independent learning. It allows children to discover their own learning styles and learning abilities instead of having so much focus on group work. My son is able to focus more on what he's interested in. A few months ago, he started picking up writing, reading and sight words. The one-on-one attention was one of the main reasons we decided to choose Maria Montessori International Academy after we looked at several schools."

Cathy Briney

Parent of 4-year-old

3,029

Graduates

17

Years since Opening

1,286

Montessori Experiences

87

Countries Explored

UPCOMING CLASSES AND PROGRAMS

2017-18 Enrollment

The journey towards lifelong learning begins at Maria Montessori International Academy! We're now accepting applications for the 2017-18 MMIA school year. We have a limited number of openings in our infant, toddler and elementary school programs. We look forward to you joining the MMIA family.

Register

Mommy & Me Music Rhapsody

Join us for our exciting new Music Rhapsody program, which was developed by internationally renowned music educator Lynn Kleiner. This music program, which is exclusively offered by MMIA in the Indianapolis area, fosters a love of music and creativity in children with the use of instruments, beautiful songs and singable phrases. Classes are designed for infants and toddlers.

Register

"The goal of early childhood education should be to activate the child's own natural desire to learn."

- Maria Montessori

Contact us for more information!



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About Maria Montessori International Academy (MMIA)

In 2001, Maria Montessori International Academy (MMIA) opened its doors as one of the first private schools in Indiana to offer an authentic Montessori education. Vivian Cain, MMIA founder and lead directress, was inspired to provide Indianapolis-area children with the same educational environment used to encouraged children to flourish in an Italy school more than a century ago.

That earlier school environment, established by Maria Montessori in 1907, has since been proven to nurture the whole child in real life, allowing each Montessori student to fully develop through exploration. Studies have shown that Montessori students excel in reading, math, science, independent thinking and innovation.

To meet community demand, MMIA expanded over the years. In addition to its original location in a charming historical house on Indianapolis' northside, MMIA has locations in Zionsville and Carmel. Each school features bright, nature-filled settings, Montessori-certified learning tools, low student-to-teacher ratios, Spanish-immersion lessons, specialized musical programs, and Montessori programs designed for children from infancy to elementary school.

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Maria Montessori Method

At MMIA, we are committed to the methods established by Maria Montessori. Within just a few years of her starting this innovative learning environment, educators around the world were recognizing the progress made by Montessori students. MMIA adheres to the traditional Montessori method which features:

Independent learning: An MMIA classroom encourages children to learn and play independently, and in small and large groups. Children are able to move about freely, choosing activities that interest them. Teachers help guide their work.

Montessori-certified teachers: Each of our teachers has been certified in the Montessori method and has earned a bachelor's degree and/or master's degree in education.

Child-focused environment: All items are scaled to the child's size, including furniture, shelves, utensils, dishware, cleaning implements and Montessori materials.

Community-oriented: In Montessori, there is not a "front of the classroom." This reinforces that the teacher is not the focus of the children's attention. The class operates as a community. MMIA is a child-centered environment.

Engaging environment: Each MMIA school is accented with bright colors, natural materials, plants, interesting art, and cultural objects, which are all designed to provide children with a complex sensory and intellectually stimulating environment. As soon as they enter the school, children are immediately engaged. They realize a Montessori environment is designed specifically for them. It's their space to explore.

Explore MMIA

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Montessori Principles

Our MMIA community realizes that Montessori principles are at the heart of a child's ability to learn. They are key to navigating real-life experiences, allowing a child to develop at his or her own speed and based on his or her own capacities.

RESPECT

In an MMIA environment, each child is recognized as unique individuals with unique learning styles. As such, our teachers respect children as they guide them to respect other children, adults and the materials in their environment.

DISCOVERY

With a Montessori education at MMIA, your child will have the ability to discover answers for themselves. It's one of the most important steps toward helping your child establish a lifelong love of learning and problem-solving.

INDEPENDENCE

Early on, you will see your child express the desire to "do it myself" as part of a natural human response. At MMIA, we encourage children to navigate the world around them while giving them the freedom to ask for help "to do it myself!"

Welcome to MMIA

Thank you for considering MMIA! We are excited at the prospect of welcoming your child to our community. We understand the importance of this decision. It sets the foundation for your child's life. We encourage you to explore MMIA to help you make that decision. Contact us for a tour, a conversation or our informative newsletter.

Contact us today!

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THE MMIA DIFFERENCE

During a tour of Maria Montessori International Academy (MMIA), you will observe children engaging in work independently or in multiage small or large group settings. This environment encourages peer-to-peer learning, a key component of an authentic Montessori institution. At a young age, children at MMIA engage in real-life activities, including setting the table, gardening, cooking, washing dishes, and putting away their personal belongings and Montessori materials.

Through some guidance, children also choose their activities throughout the day, with the freedom to work for uninterrupted blocks of time. Each MMIA school offers a bright, engaging setting that is fully equipped with genuine Montessori learning materials, gardens, and furnishings ideally scaled for children.

MMIA provides numerous family-friendly options to cater to both working and stay-at-home parents. We offer flexible options of Full-Day, Half-Day, and Extended Care programs. With MMIA's enriched Summer Program, children can continue to learn in a Montessori environment year-round.

EARLY DISCOVERY: INFANTS, TODDLERS

At Maria Montessori International Academy, we consider this period the Wonder Years! MMIA is among the few schools that offer a Montessori environment for children in infancy. By observing children from birth, Dr. Maria Montessori recognized these early years represent the beginning of The Absorbent Mind. The first stage of this development is from birth to 3 years of age. The minds of children are being formed by the sights and sounds surrounding them – absorbed into the unconscious mind. It is a critical part of the child's development.

Infants in MMIA

Montessori for babies? Absolutely! As part of a Montessori program for the youngest members of the MMIA family, we design a calm environment that is attuned to your child's perceptions of touch, sight, sound and smell. Soothing music, natural Montessori materials and touches of nature are introduced to our infants to facilitate quality sensory experiences.

Our teachers show respect for our infants as encouraged by the Montessori philosophy, during feeding time, diaper changing time and other activities. During this stage, children are learning the foundation of language – from cooing to responses from adults.

Toddlers in MMIA

During the toddler stage, your child gains more confidence in navigating his or her surroundings. In mixed-age settings, children will naturally observe their older peers, learning real-life tasks and exploring language, mathematical concepts and gross and fine motor skills. Older children will adapt to leadership roles. At MMIA, children learn language, mathematical concepts and science through sensorial experiences provided by Montessori materials.

Our Montessori-certified teachers provide guidance in the child's development as children broaden their experiences throughout the school.

Learn More

OUR JOURNEY CONTINUES: AGES 3 to 5

By the time children in Maria Montessori International Academy reach the age of three, they're actively engaged in working with materials that expand their understanding of the world around them. They're gaining self-dependence in their quest for gaining knowledge through hands-on materials.

What to expect

New Montessori parents are often surprised at the independence 3- to 5-year-olds exhibit at MMIA. It's often remarkable to see a 3-year-old pour water from a pitcher, organize her or his own belongings and focus on her or his tasks, while 4-year-olds read an entire book. Our MMIA curriculums for 3- to 5-year-olds include Geography, Culture, Geometry, History, Spanish, Chinese and practical life skills.

Activities

Montessori tools and materials for this age group invite children to complete work, as it is called, that encourages further development. For example, the Pink Tower helps children use and enhance their coordination, concentration and problem-solving skills while grasping an understanding of various dimensions. They also may work individually or in multi-age groups.

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GROWING IN KINDERGARTEN

During the ages of 5 and 6, children experience different levels of what has been called the "Explosion of Growth" by Maria Montessori and other child development researchers. Children in Montessori programs often start writing, understanding and expressing language and engaging in reading at surprisingly advanced levels during the kindergarten years.

What to expect

As they do in earlier stages, children move freely throughout the MMIA environment, choosing activities that interest and challenge them. They also can choose to work individually with a teacher, individually, or in small or large groups.

Their movements are unrestricted by the teacher unless it endangers themselves, other people, or their surroundings. Outdoor environments are important in Montessori schools, and offer opportunities for children to engage with the natural world.

Activities

Children in Kindergarten-level classrooms are advancing to more deeply grasp various subjects, including Language Arts, Math, Social Studies, Science, Foreign Languages, Geometry, Fine Arts, and Music Appreciation. Montessori learning is integrated, paving the way to a natural understanding of various components of a discipline. As part of a Human Relations curriculum, students learn about culture, including geography, history, anthropology, astronomy, biology, botany, chemistry, economics, geology, government, philosophy, physics, political behavior, sociology and zoology.

MMIA SCHEDULE OPTIONS

Full Day

Maria Montessori International Academy offers a full-day experience from 8:30 p.m.– 3:30 p.m. This option is available for Infants and Toddlers (3 months to 3 years); Preschool, Kindergarten, and Elementary for a 3-day, 4-day or 5-day option. Monthly tuition rates vary based on grade and location.

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Half Day

At MMIA, families have the option of a half-day curriculum that is available from 8:30 a.m. – 12:30 p.m. The option is available for Infant, Toddler, Preschool and Kindergarten with 3-day, 4-day or 5-day options. Fees vary depending on number of days and school location.

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Extended Care

Families with a need for additional flexibility can choose Extended Care hours, which are from 7 a.m. – 5:30 p.m. This option is available for Infants, Toddlers, Preschool, Kindergarten and Elementary. Fees vary, depending on 3-day, 4-day or 5-day options and location.

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Summer Camp

Maria Montessori International Academy offers a year-round program through summer camp, which reinforces the Montessori curriculum. Our engaging programs also include fun lessons in science, music, dance, cooking and theater. We also enjoy indoor and outdoor activities, such as ice skating and swimming.

Register

Montessori Philosophy

At Maria Montessori International Academy, we integrate the Montessori philosophy in all aspects of our curriculum. Our MMIA family truly believes in the principles that Dr. Maria Montessori espoused more than 100 years ago. We see the amazing developments and strides children make through an environment that encourages them to innovate, explore and discover.

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EARLY DISCOVERY: INFANTS, TODDLERS

Maria Montessori's research revealed that children are learning from the moment they are born. Establishing an environment that is attuned to their perspective of the world is essential for their development.

At Maria Montessori International Academy, our infant program is distinguished by quiet low-light settings and soothing music that help infants make the adjustment from their mothers' wombs. We encourage children with their natural desire to explore the world around them and become self-sufficient. We provide natural materials that their small hands can grasp.

Our MMIA family understands the wonderful journey of learning your child is embarking upon. We're excited to offer the following programs designed for newborns to toddlers.

MONTESSORI MOMMY AND ME

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Many families desire educational opportunities as part of their child's early development. Our MMIA Mommy and Me program was designed with those opportunities in mind. We offer programs for children ages 3 months to 18 months, and programs for children 18 months to 3 ½ years.

Our Music Rhapsody program, an exclusive offering in Indiana, is one of the leading childhood music programs in the nation. Developed by internationally known music educator Lynn Kleiner, the program acknowledges a child's innate ability to make and move to music.

It cultivates creativity in your child by helping them to develop a love of music in an engaging environment. You and your child will bond as you sing songs together and play with special instruments.

Our program is called Mommy and Me, but fathers are welcome as well!

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EL NIDO: 3 to 18 MONTHS

El Nido, the infant program at Maria Montessori International Academy Infant Program, was developed using the philosophies of Dr. Maria Montessori, the founder of the Montessori Method, and Resources for Infant Educators (RIE). We are committed to the mutual philosophies of Montessori and RIE to maintain a goal of respect between your child and our caregivers.

El Nido is ideally suited to provide a smooth transition between your home and MMIA's caregiving environment. As part of basic routines, whether it's feeding, diapering or initiating naptime, our caregivers treat your child as an individual. We speak respectfully to each child, ensuring that we gain their trust.

We also understand that each child learns and develops in their own way and at their own pace. An infant's natural work is playing and exploring the world around them. The MMIA environment for infants is orderly, aesthetically pleasing, and safe for the developmental level of your child. In addition to a soothing setting, we provide an environment that is focused on natural lighting, the use of natural materials, including wood furnishings and toys, and a calm and quiet environment that is accentuated by soothing music.

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TODDLER PROGRAM

Designed for children from 18 months to 36 months, the Toddler Program at Maria Montessori International Academy is designed to encourage children to express their independence, from returning materials to their proper places, setting the table and watering plants to caring for themselves and interacting with other children in a respectful manner. Our MMIA atmosphere and Montessori materials encourage toddlers to develop their coordination, grow in their independence and self-esteem, and develop expressive and comprehensive language skills.

If you visit MMIA, you'll find toddlers purposefull engaging in work, the term that Dr. Maria Montessori used to describe the use of various materials in the school setting. These can include the following:

Language-enrichment materials: We strongly adhere to the Montessori philosophy that children are able to absorb language from their environment. These are the building blocks for their ability to learn how to talk, read and write. Many MMIA students are reading by the age of 4. The foundation starts in the toddler years, the period of the Absorbent Mind, as Dr. Montessori described it.

Coordination materials: Eye-hand coordination is an essential part of a child's development. MMIA uses colorful, natural materials that promote eye-hand coordination. These can include a variety of activities, including gluing. Practical life materials: An important part of a Montessori environment, practical life skills are developed through a child's day-to-day activities. Through preparing their own food or putting on their own clothes, a child is able to gain independence and confidence.

The Toddler community is kept small, intimate, and flexible with regard to planned activities so that the needs of the children are adhered to at all times rather than a plan created by the adults. There should be a feeling of joy in this environment as these young children are given freedom. They are not given license to do whatever they want, but they are given freedom within a structure that caters to their developmental needs.

The Absorbent Mind

Dr. Maria Montessori, drawing upon earlier philosophies, recognized the period from birth to early childhood as the period of the Absorbent Mind, developed through what she called Sensitive Periods. She divided them into four areas that your child experiences as part of their development. The following is a summary of those four areas.

Movement

Babies are moving, stretching and exploring with their limbs, even before birth. Instructors of Montessori understand the importance of providing children the ability to continue that exploratory movement, using their fingers, hands, legs and feet to connect with the intriguing objects surrounding them. We encourage an environment that provides infants with free, safe movement so that they can further develop eye-hand coordination. It's important that a child not be constrained in their ability to move at the early stages of their development.

Language

Communication is key to a child's development. As you speak to your infant, you may seem them intent on watching your lips and expressions. This is evidence of a baby's interest in language and the connections made through conversations and other sounds. In Montessori, the development of language is reinforced through a teacher talking and singing to an infant, practices that parents naturally engage in at home. Through imitation, children will start moving their own mouths and making sounds to develop their ability to communicate with those around them.

Sensory perception

Touch, taste, sound, smell and taste are all new and important perceptions in the life of an infant. As such, the Montessori philosophy is centered on ensuring those sensorial perceptions are engaging without being overwhelming. We choose soothing music, natural materials and elements of nature to accommodate a child's need for a welcoming sensorial experience of their world. We keep those elements simple, whether it is a classical tune played at a low volume or a chunky round wooden toy.

Order

To help infants and toddlers make sense of their world, it's important to develop an orderly environment that promotes familiarity and calmness. At Maria Montessori International Academy, we understand the need for children to be in an environment that is calm and welcoming. Throughout our schools, we facilitate familiar surroundings by keeping items simply furnished and organized. As children develop, they learn the concept of putting objects back into their dedicated places.

"The education of even a small child, therefore, does not aim at preparing him for school, but for life. " — Dr. Maria Montessori

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MONTESSORI FOR 3- TO 5-YEAR-OLDS

Your child is truly unique, with interests they find captivating and worthy of further exploring. As described by Dr. Maria Montessori, children are exhibiting the characterisits of the Absorbent Mind. At Maria Montessori International Academy, we're committed to helping children at these ages develop physically, emotionally, and cognitively at their own pace as part of the Preschool and Kindergarten program.

Our Montessori curriculum is designed to help each child gain self-esteem, independence, physical development, and academic achievement — the ingredients of a thirst for lifelong learning.

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"A child needs freedom within limits."

During the ages of 3 to 5, children are further exploring their creativity and imagination. Encourage them to do so independently! At Maria Montessori International Academy, we establish an environment that is designed to help children at this age level to thrive and grow in their understanding of the world around them.

With the Montessori method of learning, as Dr. Maria Montessori envisioned it, children are given the "freedom to select what attracts him in his environment, to relate to it without interruption and for as long as he likes, to discover solutions and ideas and select his answer on his own, and to communicate and share his discoveries at will."

It is important during these early stages of development that children are given the ability to choose their work in an environment that encourages discovery. When a child is allowed to move about freely and engage in purposeful work, she is able to independently and actively embrace challenges. She is able to find solutions through actively working on a task. She is setting the foundation of her lifelong interest in exploring, innovating and learning.

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DEVELOPING THROUGH PRACTICAL LIFE SKILLS

Learning about life with day-to-day activities

Practical Life lessons are an essential component of the Montessori method of learning. By learning how to master day-to-day tasks, children gain the confidence to function in their own environment. Practical Life lessons have been shown to help a child gain independence, both physically and mentally. They also learn the important skills of coordination, muscular control, concentration, perseverance and balance. As part of a community, they also learn to gain respect for others.

Specific practical life activities include:

- Care of self: Washing hands, grooming, dressing
- Care of inside environment: Dusting, sweeping, polishing
- Food preparation: Setting a table, preparing fruit, pouring
- Care of outside environment: Watering plants, raking leaves, weeding
- Grace and courtesy skills: Greetings, shaking hands, interrupting

Characteristics of practical life skills:

- Reality-based: Wash real dirty dishes with real soapy water, clean shoes with real polish and prepare fruit with real utensils
- Sequential: Activities have a beginning, middle and end, such as taking dishes to sink, preparing soapy water, cleaning and drying dishes

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EXPLORATORY SUBJECTS FOR LEARNING

To the children in our MMIA early childhood programs, work seems like play. All that play ios focus on the following areas of development:

SENSORIAL

Many Montessori materials are focused on the Sensorial area of development, with the goal of refining and developing the five senses. This is cultivated through the classification, contrasting, and comparison of color, shape, smell, feel, weights, temperature and textures through activites. These broaden a child's ability to proceed to a higher level.

MATHEMATICS

The primary purpose of numerous Montessori activities is to lay a sound number and geometry foundation. Children gain an understanding of numbers, quantities and the decimal system. They also learn basic operations of addition, multiplication, subtraction and place value, along with fractions and measurements.

LANGUAGE

In Montessori envrionments, pre-reading and pre-writing skills are emphasized in a sensorial manner. Vocabulary, drama, and diction are an integral part of the curriculum at Maria Montessori International Academy. When a child is ready to read and write, they advanced to different levels of reading materials and workbooks. Children are given their own journals in which they can practice their letters and write words. Our teachers encourage each child to write creatively.

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SOCIAL STUDIES

Our MMIA students enjoy exploring world cultures, geography, history, maps, calendar, time and holidays as part of an engaging social studies curriculum.

SCIENCE

The students study living and nonliving things, plants and their parts, animals and their parts, life cycles, metamorphosis, and the physical sciences. They also explore seasons and temperature as part of the science curriculum.

ART

The child already has been working on developing fine motor skills before being able to create their own works of art. The child is also introduced to all forms of art expression, including the works of famous artists like Van Gogh and Cezanne.

MUSIC

As part of the music curriculum at Maria Montessori International Academy, children develop skills and appreciation for music through instruments and group singing. Specific activities include Bell exercises to help develop perceptions of high-low, matching and scale. Children are exposed to different types of music from around the world.

SPANISH

Through Spanish lessons taught by native Spanish-speaking instructors, students learn to engage in conversations. They exchange everyday information with peers, and express basic needs, feelings, emotions and opinions. The children give and follow simple instructions in Spanish, and plan and carry out activities in groups.

IMAGINATIONS WELCOMED HERE!

"Our aim is not merely to make the child understand, and still less to force him to memorize, but so to touch his imagination as to enthuse him to his innermost core." - Dr. Maria Montessori

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KINDERGARTEN

Throughout our Kindergarten program, children are expressing more independence, developing a mastery of language, and gaining an understanding of numerous subjects, including science, mathematics, social studies and foreign languages. Students who have been in the Montessori program for two, three or four years are building upon the foundation of the materials they already have learned. They are voracious readers and communicators. They are expressing confidence and leadership skills. They are exploring their strengths and building upon other skills by taking on new challenges every single day.

TIME OF EXPLOSIVE LEARNING!

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When describing the period represented by the Kindergarten years, Dr. Maria Montessori described it as an "explosion of learning." During the past 15 years, our instructors at Maria Montessori International Academy fully understand what she meant by that expression. We witness those explosions among the students who are continue to build upon the concepts they have learned through sensorial activities. Something clicks after years of absorbing different concepts and they're flourishing with their mastery of different subjects.

After their involvement in sensorial activities, including working with sandpaper letters, children are reading expressively and with a deeper level of comprehension. They are further developing their creativity and cursive handwriting with their personal journals. Kindergarten students also are mastering mathematical concepts, including geometry, addition and subtraction, decimals and fractions. Learning happens daily as they explore and master more challenging work.

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EXPERIENCING MONTESSORI IN THE KINDERGARTEN YEARS

At the Kindergarten level, children are confident in their environment and community. They have adapted to their roles in multi-age settings and are emerging as leaders. They have embraced practical life skills and mastered many of the foundational practices that have prepared them for more advanced lessons. MMIA students have learned many of the practices that will pave the way for them to become invaluable contributing members of their communities. Here are some of the characteristics of MMIA kindergarteners:

- Ability to concentrate for extended periods of time
- Demonstrated problem-solving abilities
- Interpersonal and communication skills
- Understanding of what it means to follow a sequence in problem solving
- Patience in resolving a challenging task
- Purposeful in making positive choices
- Acting independently in selecting constructive work
- Purposefully engaged in roles within a community

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LEADERSHIP SKILLS

In addition to academic skills, Maria Montessori International Academy students are gaining essential life lessons that will help them navigate choices and tasks in real-life situations. As part of the MMIA environment, students are learning what it means to be a leader in their school environment. In the mixed-age setting, they can demonstrate leadership skills with younger children. Their day-to-day activities also encourage students to confidently take the initiative with their tasks.

PROBLEM-SOLVING SKILLS

As part of our MMIA curriculum, problem-solving happens every day! Mathematical concepts are integrated in many of our problem-solving activities. In the early years of a Montessori education, children have been working with materials that help them grasp the concepts of addition, subtraction, multiplication and division. Kindergarten paves the way to more a deeper comprehension of math – one of the most important steps toward gaining real-life problem solving skills.

LANGUAGE DEVELOPMENT

In the Kindergarten years, much of the experiences children have engaged with throughout their Montessori education have led them to the point that they are reading and writing fluently and expressively. During these years, students at MMIA also are developing their creative writing skills through storytelling. They are grasping the difference between nouns, adjectives, verbs, adverbs and other aspects of grammar. They also explore other languages of various cultures.

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SOCIAL STUDIES

At MMIA, our students gain an understanding of countries by studying the geographical aspects of the land the people who live there. We explore how they live, communicate and navigate their surroundings. We bring social studies to life.

SCIENCE

Through our science program, which includes botany, chemistry, physics, astronomy and zoology, children in Kindergarten develop scientific principles through an exploratory process. They learn to appreciate the vastness of the universe, including the study of the intricate life cycle of plants and animals.

ART

Throughout Kindergarten, students continue to explore the fine arts by expressing their own creativity and developing a natural appreciation of the works of art masters. We explore art in its many forms, including paintings and sculptures.

MUSIC

Children engage in musical expression throughout all stages of a Montessori environment. As the children advance into Kindergarten, they already have experienced music as an integral part of their day-to-day activities. They use musical instruments, including bells and tone bars, participate in group singing and gain an appreciation of different types of music, including classical, world and folk music.

SPANISH

Through language immersion, students learn how to count, greet one another and express feelings in Spanish. In addition, they explore various characteristics of Spanish culture to gain a deeper understanding of the language.

OUR SIGN OF SUCCESS

“The greatest sign of success for a teacher is to be able to say, ‘The children are now working as if I did not exist.’” - Dr. Maria Montessori

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ELEMENTARY

In the Elementary program (grades 1-3), the focus is on developing the whole child through interaction with an interdisciplinary curriculum, designed specifically to meet the needs of children at this stage of development. This curriculum is implemented through use of extensive timelines which allow the child to discover the interrelatedness of all living things.

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LANGUAGE ARTS

Language is an important part of the Montessori curriculum. Its treatment as a separate subject come only at the points in which it is necessary to give clarity to the child's mind – that is, to give each student a conscious awareness of language in order that it may be used more effectively. Once the child has an understanding that writing is a graphic form of language, these special points graduate toward spelling, word study, penmanship, grammar, punctuation, and capitalization, later followed by reading quality literature and creative writing.

FOREIGN LANGUAGE

The students learn how to read, write, and speak French and/or Spanish. The teacher (a native of France) converses daily in French so the children can practice their conversational skills with each other. The goal for each child is to read and write in a different language.

MATHEMATICS

As in other parts of the Montessori curriculum, experience with a material comes first, then the spoken language or naming. This is followed by the symbolic representation or written symbol. In Montessori mathematics, this sequence is referred to as "quantity, symbol, and association." Such concepts taught include addition, subtraction, multiplication, division, fractions, squaring, decimals, estimation, and percentages.

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GEOMETRY

Geometry lessons are experienced sensorially through manipulation of both plane and solid geometric figures. These materials induce a creative activity that encloses two- and three-dimensional construction of various forms, artistic drawings, and ornamentation. For example, most children would recognize a certain geometric image – with four partially overlapping circles – as a flower. However, to a Montessori child it is a quatrefoil, a design commonly found in architecture. This is just one of many examples of how the Montessori method integrates several disciplines into one lesson.

SOCIAL STUDIES AND SCIENCE

Dr. Montessori felt that social studies and science should be integrated in the classroom, as they are in life. Therefore, no clear distinctions exist among any of the various areas included in this section when they are studied in the classroom. This sequence is comprised of a Human Relations curriculum that serves as an organizing center in the "cultural" subjects, especially geography and history. Anthropology, astronomy, biology, botany, chemistry, economics, geology, government, philosophy, physics, political behavior, sociology, and zoology are also included.

ARTS AND CRAFTS

The teacher aids the child in the development of skill in order that the child may creatively express himself or herself through various media. The teacher introduces geometrical drawings, geographical maps, architecture, physics, etc., which are tightly interwoven with other parts of the overall curriculum. Weekly professional art lessons through the Indianapolis Art Center's "ArtReach" program are also provided.

MUSIC APPRECIATION

Singing provides children with a repertoire of melodies that they can use when producing and analyzing music. The feelings expressed by a piece of music, such as a folk song or composition of a great composer, can be absorbed by children. All Elementary students participate in the Montessori Bells and singing classes to help acquire an ability to read music. Private piano lessons are available after school through a private teacher. Arrangements are made between parent and piano teacher.

JOIN THE MMIA COMMUNITY!

"There is a great sense of community within the Montessori classroom, where children of differing ages work together in an atmosphere of cooperation rather than competitiveness. There is respect for the environment and for the individuals within it, which comes through experience of freedom within the community." – Dr. Maria Montessori

THRIVING IN A MONTESSORI COMMUNITY

One of the core characteristics of a Montessori school is a warm and welcoming community for your child. A safe, encouraging environment is vital to the social, emotional and intellectual development of all children in Maria Montessori International Academy. To ensure that we maintain that environment, we focus on activities that encourage our students to develop a deep respect for each other, their surroundings and their belongings.

We focus on the principles of honesty, trust and accountability to foster a nurturing community among all students.

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SUMMER FUN CAMP 3- TO 10-YEAR-OLDS

Are you ready for a summer of fun? Join us for an adventure you won't forget! Our summer school program includes the following activities from June through August 2017.

July 10 -14: School Open: Wrap around Care – Teacher Music Training

July 17 - 28: Spanish Immersion: Enjoy summertime fun through a two-week Spanish-filled cultural excursion. Lango campers spend each week immersed in an exciting part of the Latin American world. They include:

Welcome to the Latin Kitchen: Delectable recipe! YUM! Students will learn to make Hispanic dishes from scratch where the student will perform all the food prep from dicing, blending, grading and mixing to create delectable eats from Latin America to create tropical salads to Yucca Chip with homemade avocado dressing for dipping to Morir Sonando Tropical drinks, Lucy Lime Fizz and Coconut Lime Pie Shake. Delectable treats indeed!

Language: Students will learn the Montessori Curriculum in Spanish along with Spanish books, music, and puppets to enhance the curriculum.

Dance: Students will dress in authentic costumes to learn the Meringue Dance of the Dominican Republic, which will culminate in a dance performance for the parents.

Cultural Outing: After a dance performance, parents and students are invited to travel to the best Cuban restaurant in Indianapolis where the students will learn to order food and engage in basic greetings in Spanish Cuban style.

July 31 – Aug. 4: Trikes and Bikes and Obstacle Course: Put on those helmets and bring your bikes or trikes to school! Race and dash through creative and fun obstacle courses to make your way through cones, laundry baskets, car washes and tires, etc. What a fun way to great exercise!

August 7 – 11 Tie-dye Week: Watch your child's face light up when you remove that first rubber band from their tie dyed T-shirt. It is truly amazing the designs that one can create with so few tools. See what rubber bands, marbles, crumbling, scrunching or twisting the fabric can do to create unique patterns and spirals!!

Contact us today!

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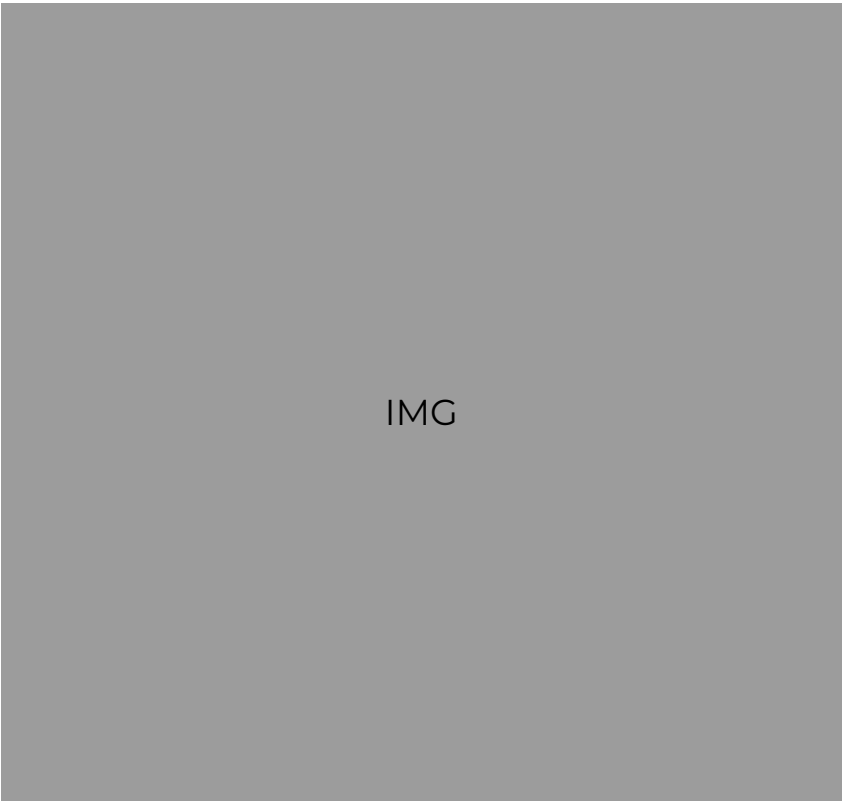
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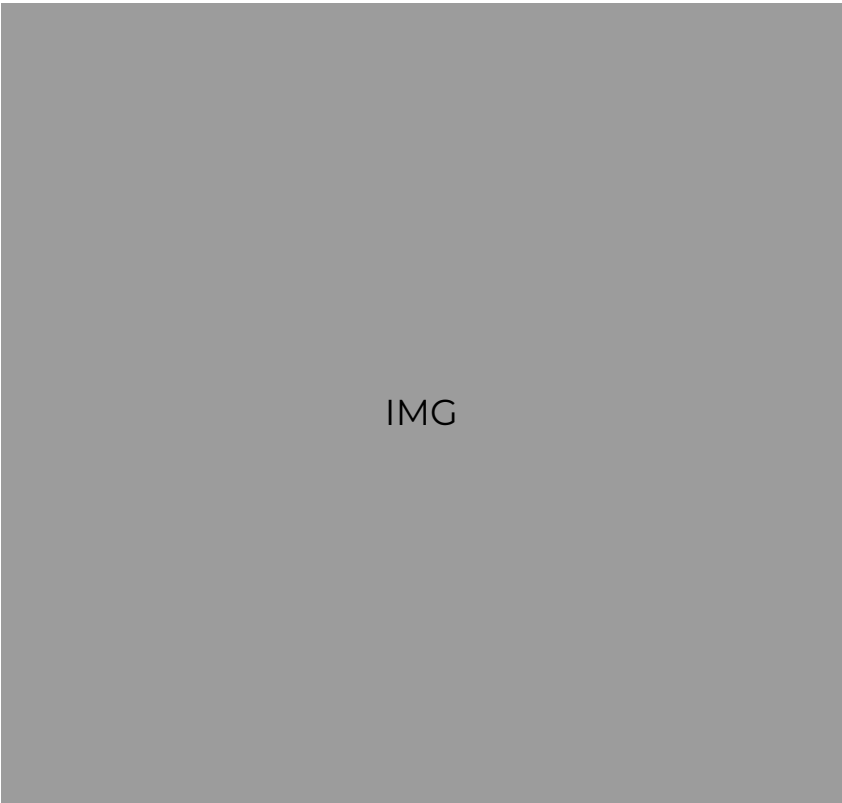


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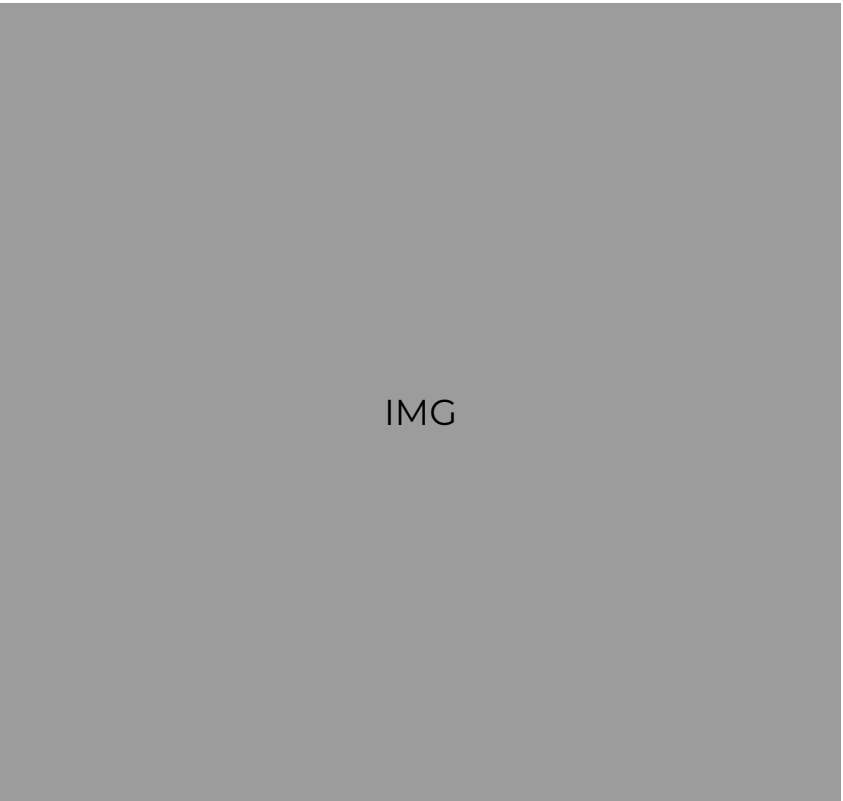
From Google to Amazon, how a Montessori education is generating tech innovators

The founders of Google and Amazon are just a few of the latest innovators to link their outside-of-the-box thinking to Montessori. Google CEO Larry Page said a Montessori education allowed him to be self-motivated, question what's going on in the world and try to do things a bit differently. Read about six other well-known innovators who attended a Montessori school [here](#).



What's the difference between Montessori, Waldorf and Reggio Emilia?

Unless you're already familiar with teaching philosophies, understanding the differences can be challenging. Families often are drawn to a Montessori education because it fosters a child's natural desire to learn independently. Waldorf has a play-based approach with an emphasis on a predictable structure. Reggio Emilia focuses on citizenship. Read more [here](#) in PBS.org about various school philosophies.



How to pick a preschool in one hour or less: Tips from a UC-Berkely professor

While you probably are spending quite a bit of time researching options for preschool, your family's visit to a school is one of the most important steps in the process. When taking a tour of different schools, there are some important observations you should make, according to a professor from the University of California. Read his recommendations [here](#) in an article for the New York Times.



A Montessori education could be the key to thinking like a genius, expert says

Dr. Maria Montessori was among the most disruptive leaders in recent generations. Her observations of children in mental institutions led her to some surprising conclusions. As a result, she developed the Montessori Method to encourage respect for children instead of requiring them to sit still listening to a teacher's recitation. Read more about those roots in this article by the [Houston Chronicle](#).

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RESOURCES FOR FAMILIES

As a parent or caregiver, you have a unique and essential role in your child's development. We encourage you to support your child's natural inclination to explore and discover — important aspects of their education. At MMIA, we understand that important connection.

Regularly visit our site for a variety of child development resources that you can introduce into your home. Sign up for our newsletter for insightful tips for infants, toddlers, and elementary-age students. We will also keep you updated on educational news and family-friendly events throughout Central Indiana.

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Bringing Montessori Home

Many of our families express an interest in incorporating elements of the Montessori methods into their homes. We strongly encourage our families to reinforce a Montessori atmosphere at home! It provides more consistency in creating opportunities for self-expression, independence and orderliness. Here are 10 suggestions to consider for toddlers.

1. Use hooks that allow your child to organize his or her belongings.
2. Assist your child in returning items to their place after using them.
3. Provide child-sized utensils and dishes in the kitchen.
4. Use step stools to allow your child to reach the sink.
5. Set up a reading corner with pillows, blankets and a basket of books.
6. Place a world map on the wall of the child's bedroom.
7. Add potted plants to the home, indoors and outdoors.
8. Allow your child to help with cleaning and other chores.
9. Organize your home so everything has a place.
10. Bring music into the home.

Want to learn more about MMIA and the Montessori philosophy? Download a copy of our MMIA Family Handbook.

Family Handbook

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Helping your family adjust

At Maria Montessori International Academy, we realize the importance of helping your child adjust to a new environment. We're committed to helping your child feel at home. Our Montessori environment is designed to help ease the transition from your home to our MMIA home. We encourage children to navigate their new surroundings in a natural, colorful setting that features child-sized bookcases, sinks, furniture and plenty of natural lighting. Don't forget your slippers! We want you to feel at home.

We realize that adapting to a new environment is an adjustment period for families as well. That's why we encourage you to visit our schools to see other children engage in their activities as part of their daily routines. We also offer special trial periods in which your child can experience the Montessori environment before you commit to full enrollment.

Contact us for more details. We're looking forward to you visiting us!

Ready to tour?

For many families, a Montessori environment is unlike traditional preschool or childcare they have observed. We invite you into our home at Maria Montessori International Academy to see the difference. Contact us for a tour today!

We're ready to visit MMIA.

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Contact Maria Montessori International Academy

Do you want to learn more about Maria Montessori International Academy? Are you wondering if it's the best fit for your child? Many of our MMIA families have had similar questions.

We realize the importance of choosing the right environment for your child. It's a home away from home and the foundation of your child's future. Schedule a tour today. Also, ask us about our special trial offer.

Contact MMIA

Name

Last Name

Phone number

Email

Tell us about your innovator.

Submit

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Register your child with MMIA

You've decided that Maria Montessori International Academy is the right learning environment for your child, That's great news! We're looking forward to you joining our MMIA family of innovators, explorers and life-long learners.

Let's get better acquainted. We will discuss the ideal schedule for your child and your family as you take this next step in your child's development. We also will answer any questions you may have about the day-to-day activities your child will experience. Contact us to get started.

Contact MMIA

Name

Last Name

Phone number

Email

Tell us about your explorer.

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